

Russell Dudek

AI Operations & Operating Transformation Leader

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<https://russelldudek.github.io/Ontra/>

Operator-technologist who makes complex work visible, connects technical and business teams, and builds operating mechanisms that turn emerging technology into adopted, measurable outcomes. Direct work spans AI readiness, workflow design, agentic patterns, human review, governance, evaluation, enterprise systems, training, and cross-functional operating change.

AI operations

Workflow automation

AI enablement

Human authority

Governance

Operating roadmaps

Community building

Measurement & adoption

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

Vape-Jet

2025-Present

Director of Operations

- Leads AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connects factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Works directly inside a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.

DudeWorth

2017-Present

Founder / AI and Automation Advisor

- Develops AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks that assess value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Designs agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advises on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, AMRs, ASRS, cobots, transportation systems, network analysis, and workflow design.

Amazon

2014-2018

Operations Management / Site Leader

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms; applied Lean and Gemba across safety, quality, throughput, customer experience, and team engagement.
- Served on the Amazon Prime Now launch team with Whole Foods and contributed to logistics innovation through Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

ROLE-ALIGNED OPERATING POSTURE

Centralize the mechanism; keep judgment and outcomes with accountable workflow owners.

HANDS-ON EVIDENCE

Observe work, structure context, build or shape interventions, test with users, instrument results, and teach the standard.

COMPLEMENTARY LEADERSHIP AND TECHNICAL DEPTH

Compunetics

2000-2013

Director of Operations and Engineering Management

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls; collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD.
- Published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

Cardinal Building Products

2021-2023

Regional Director

- Built the company's first remote regional operation and modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

ZeusVu

2018-2022

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence; designed medical drone delivery and chain-of-custody concepts.

ROLE-ALIGNED OPERATING STRENGTHS

- Translate AI capability into specific workflow, decision, authority, boundary, adoption, and evidence requirements.
- Create roadmaps and operating cadence without removing ownership from functional teams.
- Build practical standards, training, advocates, escalation paths, and reusable mechanisms.
- Connect tools and vendors to business value, adoption burden, risk, and lifecycle decisions.
- Communicate technical and operating tradeoffs to executives and non-technical users.

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Agentic AI	LLM workflows
RAG patterns	Human-in-the-loop
Python	SQL
JavaScript	TensorFlow
Tableau	ERP / Odoo
Jira / Confluence	HubSpot / Slack

SELECTED CREDENTIALS

- Google AI Essentials
- IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
- Six Sigma Certification

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh · Bachelor of Science

Academic grounding includes materials science, physical chemistry, and biology-related studies. Academic work is indexed at [Google Scholar](#).